force of Sulṭān Ali Mīrzā. Big losses came in the way of Baysonqor Mīrzā. Most of the soldiers on his side, including Ahmad Haji Beg were taken, prisoners. Most of the soldiers were put to death.

Khusrau Shah and Other Tīmūrid Mīrzās

In AD 1498, Khusrau Shah led an army from Kunduz to Chaghanian, taking Baysonqor Mīrzā with him. Loaded with wrong and traitorous intentions, he sent the following message to Ḥisār for Sulṭān Masud Mīrzā:[*]

> *Come, betake yourself to Samarkand. If Samarkand is taken, one Mīrzā may seat himself there, the other in Hisar.*

This was the period when the Mīrzā's begs and households were highly displeased by him as he had excessively favoured his father-in-law, Shaikh Abdullah Barlas who had turned his loyalty to him from Baysonqor Mīrzā. Although Ḥisār was a small district, Masud Mīrzā had allotted Shaikh a grand allowance of thousand *tumens* of *fulus* (sets of ten thousand small copper coins), with a bonus of the whole region of Khutlan which had holdings of many Mīrzā's Begs. Shaikh Abdullah and his sons also had control of Mīrzā's Gate. The displeased one began fleeing to Baysonqor Mīrzā one after another.

Having successfully deceived Masud Mīrzā and Khusrau Shah, Baysonqor Mīrzā moved out of Chaghanian, surrounded Ḥisār and took possession. By then Masud Mīrzā was stuck in Daulat Sarai, which his father had built in the suburbs.

Now unable to enter the fort, he drew towards Khultan with Shaikh Abdullah Barlas. He left his companions halfway, crossed the river at the Aubaj ferry, and made a move to Sulṭān Husayn Bayqara Mīrzā.

Khusrau Shah had already taken Ḥisār and made Baysonqor Mīrzā sit on the throne. He gave Khutlan to his younger brother Wali and then rode to lay the siege of Balkh where he garnered the support of many of his father's begs and Ibrahim Hussain Mīrzā. Then, he sent his chief retainer, Nazar Bahadur on a campaign near Balkh with eight scores of men. He along with Baysonqor Mīrzā followed Nazar's troop, laying the seige.